

R.T.O.T. 110, 55, 10, 10

A.S.N. 37, 16, 383

MAINTENANCE Division

30th Sta. Comp. Sgd.

A.P.O. 636

6/6 Post M.

New York



13

For the Base
cens



Miss. MARTHA Dannough
LUTHERAN HOSPITAL
SCHOOL OF NURSING
ST. LOUIS Mo.

March 20, 1944
England

Dear Martha,
I am getting bad in answering your letters. They are more and more each day. But I hope they keep on coming. I will answer them some time.

I have been going to town a lot and seeing the shows. I saw Stage Door Canteen & "Washington Sleep Here". Boy are they old but we have a good time seeing them. But last night after the show we went 'Outing'. I got feelin' good, but the day I was with really got feelin' good. If you know what I mean. I think about 2 or 3 more would of put me under what every you got. But we had a good time. The other two (?) boys I go out with every day are in a poker game. I hope they win because we can go out again. If they lose they will see us tomorrow so we can spend my money.

We had fresh eggs for the first time in a couple of months. I was to get one what you know or food I got 4 of them. We are to have them to morrow. I bet I could eat 6 or 7 of them.

I received your letter with the letter to Shorty. So Shorty is a cook now I will see him in the mess

2.
hall to know and get it to him. I do not
see him much now because he is looking.
I can read in your letter about me getting up
in the cold barracks. Well we got a good
stone now, but the weather is getting warmer.
and my bed is about 2 yards from the
stall and is it warm now.

I really enjoy your letter and if we do
not watch out we will be a lot more
than what we mean now. But I love to
hear how much you miss me. I cut a part
out of the "the Yankee". I know it do not
no fit ~~was~~ but it just what I think
about me time. It is pretty much like
my trip over here.

I do not know if I told you about my
thumb. I cut my fore finger on my left hand.
and now I cut my thumb on my right hand. And
now I having a hard time writing. I was out
in the park thinking of you. It was a nice
sunny day. And the two were I was
at on my part had a nice park with a river
running through it. I was laying in the grass
thinking about you + home. And just
what you are doing and how I would like

to have you in my address. I
was cutting on the branch of a tree and thinking
to hard. Because for I know it I cut a nice
piece out of my thumb. And then the blood came
and then I wish I had a nurse then. But
I guess it will get better now.

Say our A.P.O. number has been
change to 636. I hope you get it O.K.

Well I guess I better close now.

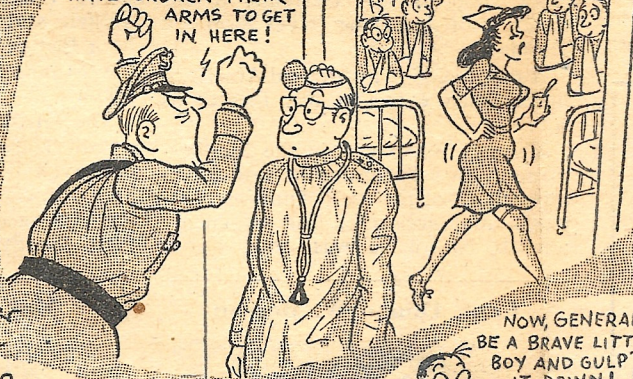
I really miss you a lot. And in
am thinking of you a lot.

Army Nurse

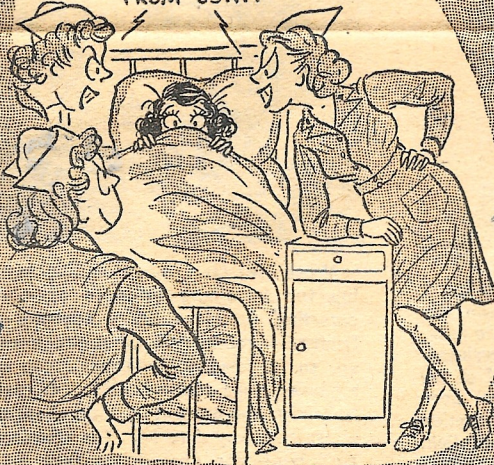


Lt. Dave Breger
Britain

HER WAR
EFFORT'S DOING
US A LOTTA HARM!
79% OF MY REGIMENT
HAVE BROKEN THEIR
ARMS TO GET
IN HERE!



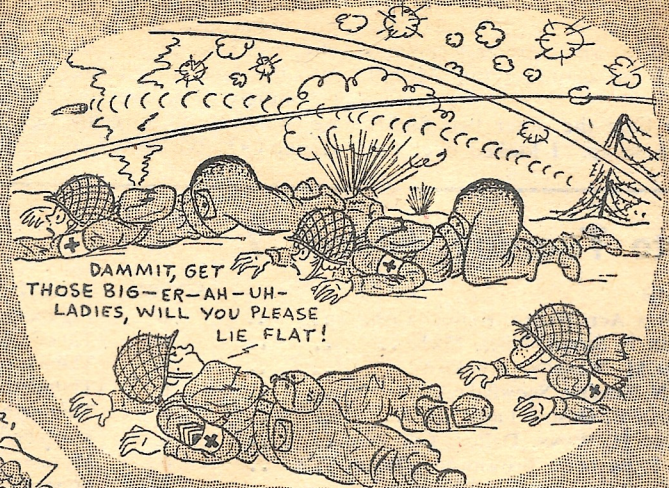
WELL, WELL! SO
YOU'RE THAT CUTE
LITTLE WAC THAT'S BEEN
LURING ALL OUR BOY FRIENDS
FROM US...!



NOW, GENERAL, SIR,
BE A BRAVE LITTLE
BOY AND GULP
IT DOWN!



DAMMIT, GET
THOSE BIG-ER-AH-UH-
LADIES, WILL YOU PLEASE
LIE FLAT!



THE COLONEL'S
ONLY GOT A
SORE THROAT,
BUT HE'S THE
BIGGEST WOLF
IN THE E.T.O.!





Thoughts in the Night

By Pvt. ELLIOT A. WITTEN

He bundled up tighter in his coat. Br-r-r, but it can get cold on the ocean, even if the fresh wind does smell nice and salty. Not quite as nice

hadn't got as much out of life as he deserved. Just wait till this war is over—just wait.

And Mom, with her meek, frightened, permanently wondrous look. So little and so lovable. His sister, my, how she was growing up. Sixteen already and a grown lady, proud of her oldest brother. And his younger brother. Mustn't forget him. Where is he now? Somewhere in the South Pacific. A good kid, a really good kid, and not a sissy.

Her mother, smart, efficient, yet worried and proud also. Her Dad, his other Dad now. He went through the last war also. A hero, too. Took off his gas mask and put it on a wounded soldier and carried him back to the rear. God, it would be tough to do that if the chance ever came. But her Dad did, and was still suffering from it after twenty-five years. For what? For a lousy hunk of ribbon? No! To make the world safe for democracy and to insure against future wars? Ha! That's a laugh. If that's true, then why was he here, why was this boatload sailing for God knows where, into what? No, that's not it.

He'd do the best he could, but he wouldn't be patriotic about it. Still, there's some satisfaction in doing a job well and right and just a little better than the best of your ability. His father and father-in-law did, and then came back and raised families. His father-in-law had two beautiful daughters, too. That sister-in-law was a cute kid. Hell, she's only thirteen now. But even at that she'll never be able to out-match her older sister, my wife. That sounds good. My wife, he thought to himself, and he said out loud for the wind and the night and the ocean to hear: "My precious, adorable kitten baby." Silly little nicknames. So meaningless to others, so vitally meaningful to him and to her.

When he left for the Army he started a new hopeful chapter in his life. Full of ambition and of a desire to get ahead, to do something. Reception centers, basic training, hikes, details, K.P., letters to his wife and to his folks and to others, but mostly to his wife. More training, waiting, hurry up and wait, finally a furlough. He'd surprise her, wouldn't tell her he was coming home. Did, too. Walked right in on her in her office. Boy, was she shocked, then happy, and, after it was all over, miserable! So he took her back with him. Back to New Orleans.

What beautiful memories they had there. So many little things. Things that didn't count to

ENGLAND—the ship cut through the night and water on its errand across the Atlantic. It would have been an impressive sight to an observer other than the crew and passengers. The ship was carrying troops to battle—troops, where before there had been wealthy, idle passengers. Then it had been all lights and gaiety and laughter. Now it was different. There were no lights, no gaiety, no laughter. Just several thousand men—grim, quiet men who had a job to do, or felt they had, or were told they had. Anyway they were there, and overflowing. They slept in the swimming pool and the lounge and on the promenade deck. Some even slept on the sun deck. There was no smoking allowed except in the smoking-room and on the promenade deck. That deck was a busy place, all right. Smokers, sleepers, strollers. You couldn't even go out on the open deck. M.P.s guarded the hatches. They had strict orders not to let anybody out.

But one did manage to get through the apparently impenetrable cordon. Hell, those erstwhile guards were soldiers too, weren't they? And if a buddy wanted a breath of fresh air, why, they understood. Even a soldier can get seasick.

But this soldier leaning over the rail and gazing out into the night wasn't seasick. He was just an escapist of sorts, or maybe a thinker. And just now he was thinking not of battle or misery or death but of the past. The great and glorious past. So little done, yet such a lot as far as he was concerned. Perhaps he could almost see himself now, a wild and wilful, spoiled brat. A show-off is the word. Perhaps he remembered those days in school when he was the idol of all the girls.

Perhaps he remembered those early love affairs he'd had. So guilty, no naïve, so miserable! Then those jobs he had—short-lived, all of them, spanning a period of six years. Six years out of only twenty-two, but God, how much they meant to him now. Yet how little in comparison to this new venture which could mean—. No, let's don't think of that angle.

He smiled a little as he remembered Chickie. Funny how he met her. He belonged to a veterans' auxiliary club because his father was a veteran in good standing. She belonged to the daughters' auxiliary. Both groups decided to go to the Fair. "Grover Whalen's Picnic," some called it. He didn't even notice her until they got there, but once he did he stayed by her side all the time from then on. Yes, from then on—.

though, as the fresh still wind that blew through the open front door of the subway as they rode back from the Fair that night. He was singing and she was accompanying him, and they both were laughing between stanzas.

He always claimed afterwards that she picked him up at the Fair. (He knew that wasn't true. He just said it to please his vanity and to tease her.) They were still laughing as they got off the train at the Columbia University's station at 116th St. She lived near there. And after that he managed to get around there very often, practically every night, in fact. Boy, they had fun together. Hikes on the Palisades, swimming at Coney Island, movies on upper Broadway, evenings at her home and at his home, delicious dinners prepared and served by her folks and his folks. Fun and laughter, petty quarrels and sentimental forgiveness, phone calls galore. She went to night college while both of them worked during the day. Three years of that. Three wonderful, glorious years. They were inseparable. Dated each other only, and why not? They were happy that way and only that way.

In 1941, July it was, he wanted to go to England. They needed fellows there in his line at that time. How she begged him not to go, and he didn't because on that certain day he suddenly discovered he didn't want to go. He wanted to stay here with her for ever. So he enlisted in the Reserves and they decided to get married finally.

How happy they were. He had to borrow money from his father (good old Dad) to pay for every thing, and even then they had so little. Such a little in some ways, yet such a helluva lot in so many others. A more devoted, perfectly matched couple couldn't be found. She was so cute, so precious, so adorable, and he—well, anyway, she loved him and that's what counted. Yes, it was perfect. Hell, it couldn't be anything but. He even loved his in-laws. Sure he did. He actually got along better with her mother and father than she did. And she got along better with his parents than he did. They adored her, too. Even his brother and sister liked her.

And then he was called up for service. He remembered that farewell dinner so well. How every one was there, how proud they were of him. Proud of what? And he smiled a little as he pictured their faces again. His father, pompous and handsome, trying his best. "Good old Dad" fits him. He

on their honeymoon night.) Played cards, and he taught her how to play blackjack while they gobbled up a pound box of candy between them. In New Orleans there were things like buying ice cream cones and having a malted at Walgreen's Lousy service there, though; too crowded. But what he wouldn't give for one of those malteds now.

But all good things have to come to an end sometime. He was scheduled to go overseas. She went back home, but not until she saw him off on the troop train. He was sent north, to an embarkation camp. Went over the hill several times in New York in order to see her, just for a while before he left. Finally he did leave, but he let her know that he was leaving. Yes, he let her know in a way that only they could understand. She knew in her heart that he was leaving, and he knew, too, that she knew.

Boarding the train (hurry up and wait, hurry up and wait, that took six hours) and then the Red Cross at the gangplank with coffee and doughnuts and chocolate. On the boat, finally. A happy gang, or at least they seemed happy or tried to appear happy. And why not? They didn't have wives at home like he did. Not most of them. None like his wife, anyway. Funny how everybody thinks that way. But not him, he knew it was true and not just a bunch of words. He could look up the river and there (although he couldn't see it, of course), only six miles away, was his home, his wife, his entire life, really. Stayed in the harbor for a day and a half and then pulled out. And now they were three days out. Three hellish days away from New York, U.S.A. Tomorrow, well let tomorrow take care of itself when it comes, if it comes.

Too cold up here, he thought. Too cold and too lonely. He left the rail and went to his bunk, way down on "D" deck below the water line. Boy, it was noisy there. Noisy and stale. A card game was going on in one corner and, in another, a crap game. Some of the fellows were lying in their bunks, reading. Others were too seasick to worry about reading or games or anything. Thank God he didn't get seasick, not yet anyway. Oh well, a little sleep now won't hurt, that is if you can sleep with all the noise and rocking and the thoughts and fears crowding your mind.

Tomorrow or the next day we'll land, and then what? Oh, if only he could look into the future. If only he could see into tomorrow and tomorrow and tomorrow. If only—. He slept.

U. ARMY EXAMINER

ARMY EXAMINER

EXAMINER